Marking Scheme
English Language and Literature

Class: X Maximum Marks: 80

General note: accept any answer that conveys the value points below, in the candidate's own words, unless the question demands a specific form. Award marks for the steps shown, not only for the final answer.

Section A – Reading

Q1. (1 mark)

Answer: b) The sound of sparrows

Q2. (1 mark)

Answer: b) A bowl of water and a feeder with millet

Q3. (1 mark)

Answer: c) Three weeks

Q4. (1 mark)

Answer: c) It left one corner of the grounds wild

Q5. (1 mark)

Answer: d) Forty-one

Q6. (3 marks)

- Rain ran off the school roof and was lost down the drains
- Nothing of the monsoon water was collected or stored
- By February the school taps ran dry

Mark split: 1 + 1 + 1

Q7. (3 marks)

- The students must do the planning themselves
- The students must keep the records of the project
- The management would pay only for materials, not for the planning work

Mark split: 1 + 1 + 1

Q8. (3 marks)

- It passes through a simple leaf filter
- The water is used for the school garden
- The water is also used for flushing

Mark split: 1 + 1 + 1

Q9. (3 marks)

- The collected water kept the school garden green through the dry months
- The school's water bill fell by nearly a fifth

Mark split: 1.5 + 1.5

Q10. (3 marks)

- The rainfall
- The tank levels

Mark split: 1.5 + 1.5

Section B – Writing

Q11. (5 marks)

- Format: name of the school or society, the word NOTICE, and the date
- A clear heading naming the competition
- Date, time, and venue of the competition
- Who may take part (Classes IX to XII) and how and by when to register names

- Name and designation of the student issuing the notice

Mark split: Format 1 + Content 3 + Expression 1

OR (alternative):

- Date and time of writing at the top
- Opening line naming the event
- Events of the day in sequence
- Personal feelings and reflections
- A closing note looking back on the day

Q12. (5 marks)

- Format: sender's address, date, receiver's address, subject line, salutation and subscription
- The present condition of the park stated in concrete detail
- Two practical improvements suggested
- A request that the authorities act, with the public benefit pointed out

Mark split: Format 1 + Content 3 + Expression 1

OR (alternative):

- Sender's address, date, and the shop's address
- Reference to the purchase: item, date, and bill if mentioned
- Clear statement of the defect and when it appeared
- A firm but polite request for a replacement or refund

Q13. (5 marks)

- A clear opening stand on the topic
- At least two supporting points or examples
- Points linked in a logical order
- A concluding line that rounds off the stand taken

Mark split: Content 3 + Expression 2

Q14. (5 marks)

- The given opening line used and carried forward naturally
- A clear sequence of events with a turning point
- Character shown through action or feeling, not only described
- An ending that grows out of the events

Mark split: Content 3 + Expression 2

OR (alternative):

- The scene set with time and atmosphere
- Sensory detail: sounds, sights, and smells of the early morning
- People and activity described in an orderly movement across the scene
- An effective closing impression

Section C – Literature and Language Study

Q15. (1 mark)

Answer: b) Ravi said that he was busy that day.

Q16. (1 mark)

Answer: b) were

Q17. (1 mark)

Answer: c) since

Q18. (1 mark)

Answer: a) The plants are watered by the gardener every morning.

Q19. (1 mark)

Answer: b) will postpone

Q20. (1 mark)

Answer: b) He is one of the best players in the team.

Q21. (1 mark)

Answer: c) is

Q22. (1 mark)

Answer: b) must

Q23. (1 mark)

Answer: c) It's a beautiful day, isn't it?

Q24. (1 mark)

Answer: b) when

Q25. (3 marks)

- It learns the names of the stones again
- The water level falls after the rains, so the stones of the river bed show once more
- The phrase suggests the river returning calmly to its familiar, quieter course

Mark split: 1 + 1 + 1

Q26. (3 marks)

- Leaves
- A broken oar
- The sky's last light (or: the smell of rain) - any three of these

Mark split: 1 + 1 + 1

Q27. (3 marks)

- It stands in the shallow water where the light gleams
- It stands on one leg, with one shadow, perfectly still
- The picture is one of patience and complete calm

Mark split: 1 + 1 + 1

Q28. (3 marks)

- He had mended clocks in the same shop for forty years
- His hands now trembled slightly
- His ears had grown sharper with age

Mark split: 1 + 1 + 1

Q29. (3 marks)

- At first he wanted to open every clock at once
- Slowly he learnt to sit still, to wind, to wait, and to listen for the uneven heartbeat inside the case

Mark split: 1.5 + 1.5

Q30. (3 marks)

- He gave Thomas his own magnifying glass
- His words: 'The tools are nothing. The listening is everything.'
- Meaning: real skill lies in patience and attention, not in the instruments

Mark split: 1 + 1 + 1

Q31. (6 marks)

- Thomas begins impatient, wanting to open every clock at once
- Working beside Mr Elias, he learns to sit still, to wind, and to wait
- He learns to listen for the small uneven heartbeat inside the brass case
- The extract suggests a craft is learnt slowly, by watching, waiting, and paying attention
- It also suggests the master's patience matters as much as the learner's effort

Mark split: Content 4 + Expression 2

Q32. (6 marks)

- Listening means patient attention, not hearing with the ears alone

- Mr Elias holds that a clock reveals its own fault to anyone patient enough to listen
- Thomas learns the same lesson: to sit still, to wind, to wait, and to hear the heartbeat inside the case
- The closing gift of the magnifying glass underlines that tools matter less than attention

Mark split: Content 4 + Expression 2

OR (alternative):

- A master of his craft: forty years in the same shop, once steady enough to hold a screw the size of a grain of rice
- Patient by principle: a clock tells you its fault if you have the patience to listen
- His hearing has sharpened with age even as his hands tremble
- Generous as a teacher: he passes his magnifying glass, and his philosophy, to Thomas